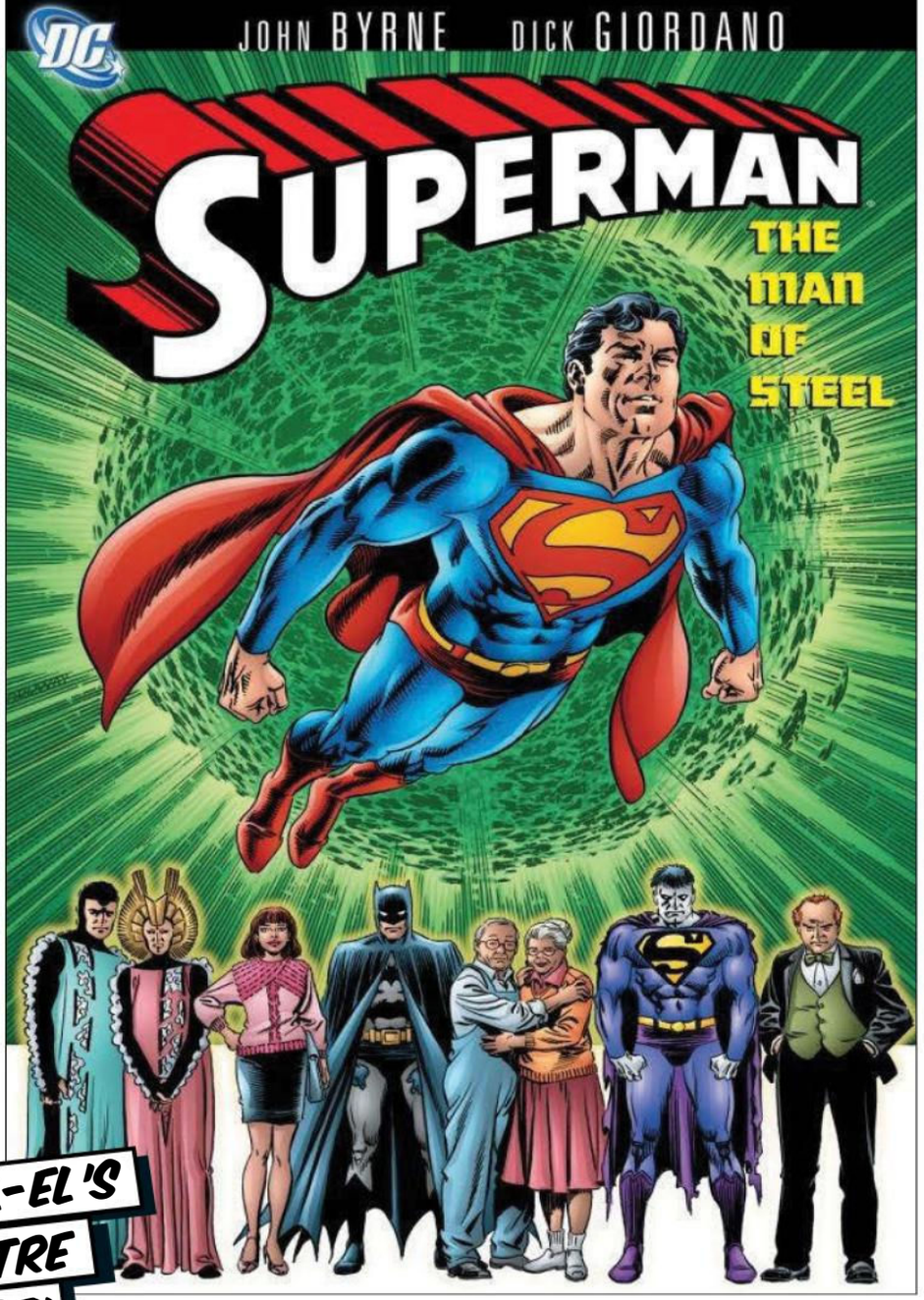
THE MAN OF STEEL

Details **Originally published** Superman: The Man of Steel #1-6 (1986) **Publisher** DC **Writer** John Byrne **Artists** John Byrne **Collected in** Superman: The Man Of Steel **Available digitally** Comixology

Many of the heroes in this volume have had their origin stories rebooted, rewritten or reconstituted out of pre-chewed chunks of terrible ideas, but few have endured/suffered it as frequently as DC's Big Blue.

Forget the *New 52* and try especially hard to forget Zack Snyder's *Man Of Steel*, as way back in 1986 writer, artist and *X-Men* alumni John Byrne rebuilt a cleaner New Testament around the inconsistent Old Testament of DC's *Last Son of Krypton*. While the trend around him moved toward nihilism and noir, Byrne proved that 'maturity' and 'hope' are by no means opposing forces.

While Frank Miller pulled the shutters down around Batman to show a world of one man alone against the night, Bryne revelled in Kal-El's place at the centre of his universe and tuned the high notes to a crystal-clear chime. He reinvented Lex Luthor as the callous corporate raider, Lana Lang as the wronged childhood sweetheart, and poor doomed Krypton a world of sterile super-science.



"BRYNE REVELLED IN KAL-EL'S PLACE AT THE CENTRE OF HIS UNIVERSE"



